

Goa has identified 20 projects under public-private partnership which will bolster its health and infrastructure services.

cation Celsa Pinto says in 2005-06, the dropout rate after Class VIII was zero, though after Class X, it was still around 40 per cent. With a budgetary allocation of Rs 322 crore for education, the state has launched schemes like the Edunet One Scheme, multi-grade teaching schemes in government schools, a plan for literacy and vocational training for adults and the setting up of educational estates to house schools. Clearly, the state has its curriculum all chalked out, but it will have to begin with some bold reforms. **by Aditi Pal**

H K RAJSHEKHAR



GEARED UP: V. Vaithilingam ready to push reforms

talent," says D. Ravikumar, writer and MLA representing Kattumannarkoil constituency from the political party Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi. "If Chennai can be an IT hub, can Puducherry be far behind?" asks M.O.H.F. Shahjahan, minister of education and IT.

Vaithilingam is also working on an image makeover for the state. "This small state has seven medical colleges and eight engineering colleges. I want to promote it as an education hub," he says.

With an area of just 492 sq km and a population of 973,829, size is the biggest administrative advantage Puducherry has. It is now up to Vaithilingam, who has already been the chief minister between 1991-96, to leverage on the same. **by S. Senthil Kumar**

6 DELHI Makeover Time

• Tops in Consumer Markets, Infrastructure

In his book, *Delhi: A Novel*, Khushwant Singh recalls when he came to the capital at the age of five, roads were being laid out with construction material coming from Badarpur on the Imperial Delhi Railway. The mega city has come a long way since, with transportation infrastructure emerging on top among 48 Indian cities, according to a report by Ernst & Young. It states Delhi has out-performed almost all cities on all (57) indicators in the infrastructure index, particularly with its road network and social infrastructure. Much credit of this development goes to the growing private sector. "Collaborative action has already been initiated in education, health care and transportation," says Rakesh Mehta, chief secretary, Delhi.

With the Commonwealth Games round the corner and the larger mandate of a world city, Delhi is set for a Rs 65,000-crore makeover, along with the expansion of the Metro network.

On the consumer front, Delhi is the country's largest market, with food, clothing and entertainment accounting for over 40 per cent of household discretionary spending. It has the highest concentration of households with an annual income of \$110,000 (about Rs 48 lakh). Minister of State for Industry, Ashwani Kumar, says a family in Delhi spends Rs 2.1 lakh per annum on an average, while it saves Rs 50,000. Needless to say, the figures have augured well for the economy. **by Nivedita Mukherjee**

Rs 2.1 lakh
is the amount a family spends each year in Delhi.

- The state is ready for a Rs 65,000-crore makeover
- Has the largest market on the consumer front



RAVI S SAHANI

For more details on the survey, log on to

<http://www.indiatoday.com>

